

**SHRI CHANDRASHEKHARENDRA SARASWATI SHAASTRA VIDYA STHAANAM – 152,
Maxworth Nagar, Kovilambakkam, Chennai – 600 029**

An institution of excellence organized and supported by the Prof. S Soundararajan Public Charitable Trust

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About the Founder

The Shri Chandrashekharendra Saraswati Shastra Vidya Sthaanam is an institution of excellence run under the aegis of the Prof S Soundararajan Public Charitable Trust. The Trust is set up in memory of Prof S Soundararajan and is inspired by his ideals and motivations. Prof. S Soundararajan had been a student and teacher of Chemistry and served as Professor in the Indian Institute of Science. Prof. Soundararajan and his wife Smt Jambakavalli had been deeply inspired by the ideals and teachings of Mahaperiyaval, Shri Chandrashekharendra Saraswati Swami, the great seer of the Kanchi Math. Prof. Soundararajan was also an ardent student of Sanskrit and was inclined towards the study of Shaastric literature.

Beginning of the Patashala

Mahaperiyaval during his earlier days had discussed with Prof. Soundararajan specific ideals related to starting of a University for Shastric studies. His Holiness wanted the traditional method of teaching the Shastras to be preserved. Prof. Soundararajan and his wife Smt. Jambakavalli had sought to devote their life and efforts to the realisation of this ideal. The Trust is committed to progress on these ideals and has established a center for excellence for Shastric studies.

The Trust is fortunate to be guided on this path by Mahamahopadhyaya Brahmashri Acharya Mani Dravid Shastri, who is its Principal Advisor and Guide. Based on the ideals and directions of Mahaperiyaval, a detailed syllabus of important texts has been identified in the Shastric subjects of Nyaya, Vedanta and Purva Mimamsa with an intent to include further topics like Vyakarana, Veda Bhashyam and other subjects.

Vision and Mission

The initial focus of the Trust, through the Shastra Vidya Sthaanam is to continue the traditional teaching processes for Shastric studies among deserving students who have demonstrated inclination towards the study of the Veda and its attendant literature. The scheme of study is aimed at providing the student with insight and knowledge of the specific Shaastram after a general period of initiation. It is expected that the students will be able to meet the demands of the qualifying exams conducted by the Kanchee Veda

Vedanta Shastra Sabha, Tenali and the Veda Shaastropabrimhana Parishad, Ahmednagar, both of which are considered to be important standard bearers in the contemporary times for the evaluation of attainment of scholarship in the Shastras.

Initial Phase of the Patashala

The initial faculty for the active task of teaching and imparting the subjects consists of Brahmashri Shreehari Dhaygude, (Rigveda Adhyayi, Vedanta Ratna, MA in Navya Nyaya and MA in Vedanta) and Brahmashri C Hariharan (Krishnayajurveda Adhyayi, MA in Mimamsa and pursuing PhD in Mimamsa).

Few students have been benefited by the activities of the Trust over the past few years. Students have been imparted instruction in Vyakaranam, Nyaya and Mimaamsaa and some students have started appearing successfully in exams conducted by various organisations. After that Brahmashri. Naveen Sharma was appointed on 2022 as a Nyaya Teacher at patashala.

Present Status of the Patashala

At present, the Pāṭhaśālā has two teachers, three regular students, and two online students pursuing studies in Nyāya Śāstra. The Pāṭhaśālā conducts weekly Vākyārtha Sabhās every Sunday. So far, 181 Sabhās have been successfully conducted, with the participation of many vidvans and students from various institutions. In addition, the Pāṭhaśālā regularly organizes academic workshops, including sessions on Nyāyabodhinī and Vyādhikaraṇa in Nyāya Śāstra, as well as the Vyavahāra Adhyāya of the Yājñavalkya Smṛti in Dharmaśāstra. Eminent scholars such as Brahmaśrī Manidraavid Śāstrigal and Brahmaśrī Devanāthan Swāmy have visited the Pāṭhaśālā and enriched the students through their erudite teachings.

Our Teachers

At present, there are two teachers at the Pāṭhaśālā. Sri Veeraraghavan holds an M.A. in Nyāya and is currently pursuing a Ph.D. He is also appearing for the Tenali examinations in Nyāya under the guidance of Brahmaśrī Naveen Sharma. Sri Shreeram Mule holds a B.A. in Nyāya and is currently pursuing an M.A. in Vedānta. He is also appearing for the Tenali examinations in Nyāya under the guidance of Brahmaśrī Vāchaspati Shastri Joshi.

Proposed Activities and Future Plans

Considering the prevalence of the virtual mode of teaching and given the convenience of students and teachers, it is proposed to reach out to deserving students in Veda Paathashalas and elsewhere to enrol in fresh batches of instruction in various topics of Shaastric studies. The Trust will facilitate the provision of

continuous instruction through online means as well as direct contact classes at regular intervals between the teachers and students so as to ensure effective education. Examinations, both oral and written will be conducted to ensure that the students and teachers understand the progress. The Trust will also disburse attractive scholarships to students who demonstrate their ability to meet specific attainments of learning and understanding. Additionally, the Trust will also provide attractive monetary Sambhavanas to its students of who successfully complete the course of study for each Shaastram. The Trust will also provide study materials to the students.

The Trust requests all like minded individuals and paathashalas to participate in this effort so that the stated ideals are attained.